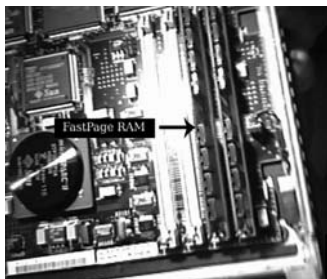


8.1 Testing the Memory

Why does one need to test RAM? If you observe poor performance even after reinstalling Windows, if the system hangs intermittently, or Windows restarts every now and then, you should check the memory for problems!

Memory problems are difficult to trace. Problems with memory often seem like problems with other areas of the system.



FastPage RAM looks a little similar to EDO RAM.

Even A Blue Screen Of Death (BSOD: a STOP error) can be caused due to a faulty memory module, but the displayed error may not specifically mention it. So, if you've had enough trouble getting your machine to work, then it's time you checked the RAM for errors.

8.1.1 How Do I Test It?

Every motherboard BIOS has a small memory test program that runs at POST (Power On Self Test). It not only tests the memory, but also counts it. The count thus obtained is compared to a count that was obtained the last time PC was operational. You will see or hear an error message if a failure is detected. The POST memory test runs quickly; it is not a thorough test to detect intermittent and subtle hardware errors.

Memory module testers are of two kinds—hardware kits and software diagnosis. We will look at the software diagnostic method of testing: hardware kits are expensive and are used by PC repair workshops.

Diagnostic tools are available on the Internet for this purpose, but one should be careful in selecting the right tool. Microsoft, too,